

ALAA GAAFAR, BDS

Medical Office Specialist | Patient Communication, Scheduling & EHR Documentation

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Qualified dentist (BDS) who practiced chairside for two years and then spent four years in operations, which is the exact pairing this seat asks for: real clinical grounding plus a proven administrative track record. In the clinic I took histories, examined and diagnosed, explained findings and costs in plain language, charted every note, booked and recalled patients, coordinated prescriptions with pharmacies and followed referrals until the patient was actually seen. In operations I have been the first point of contact for 500+ people, running scheduling, phone and email queues, confidential records, document verification and payment tracking against defined response times and across five or more systems at once. Medical terminology is my own vocabulary, not something I learned from a glossary. I chase open items to closure instead of logging them, and I am set up to work the full California business day from a private home office.

CORE SKILLS

Patient Communication & Customer Service: High-volume inbound and outbound calls alongside email and secure messaging, with nothing left sitting unanswered. Warm, clear written and spoken English at a professional level, and the habit of explaining a diagnosis, a treatment plan or a bill in words the patient will actually understand. Comfortable with distressed, elderly, reluctant or first-time patients without rushing them, and practiced at de-escalating a complaint and keeping the relationship intact. Four years of front-line service work where the patient or client never gets passed around.

Scheduling & Appointment Management: Owning a live calendar end to end: bookings, confirmations, cancellations, clashes, rescheduling and recalls, all handled the same day. In clinical practice proactive confirmation and recall was the single biggest lever on both no-show rate and whether patients completed their course of care, so I treat the schedule as clinical work rather than clerical work. Comfortable coordinating several providers, rooms and time zones at once, and protecting a clinician's day from avoidable interruptions.

EHR Documentation, Charting & Medical Terminology: BDS-qualified and practiced: medical terminology, anatomy and physiology, medication names and dosing, prescription and pharmacy workflows, referral pathways, consent and infection control. I charted findings and wrote clinical notes for a full daily caseload, so I can follow a clinician's dictation at speed without asking them to repeat the basics, and I can tell when a note does not make clinical sense. Records kept complete, consistent, confidential and audit-ready. Quick to master Epic, Cerner, athenahealth and similar EHR platforms, which run on the same patient record, scheduling and charting logic I already work in.

Medical Office Administration & Verification Work: Preparing and checking supporting documentation, submitting it to external providers and authorities, tracking each case through review and chasing it to approval rather than waiting on it. Eligibility, prior authorization and claim follow-up run on that same document, submission and chase logic. On the money side I ran registration and payment tracking for a fee-paying center, including collecting outstanding balances, reconciling accounts and following up politely. Intake, records requests and clinician support handled without needing to be asked twice.

Systems, Tools & Process: Advanced Microsoft Excel, Microsoft Office and Google Workspace; CRM and ticketing queues; Zoom and video-visit workflows; confident moving between several platforms at once and fast at learning a new one. I write the SOPs and train colleagues whenever a new system lands, and I build the automation when a manual step is costing hours: a reminder service that contacts 500+ people before their documents expire and a daily reporting dashboard used by 28+ managers, both live in production.

Reliability & Remote Working: Four years working to defined response times without supervision, with written handovers so nobody has to ask where something stands. Detail-oriented by training, since a mischarted note in dentistry is a clinical problem and not a typo. Private home office, high-speed fiber with a backup connection and power backup, HD webcam and headset. English (fluent), Arabic (native), German (conversational).

WORK EXPERIENCE

Operations and Support Specialist

Property Shop Investment (PSI) | Abu Dhabi, UAE | May 2025 - Present

- First point of contact for 500+ people: scheduling, inquiries and problems across phone, chat and email throughout the shift, most resolved the same day.
- Own confidential documentation end to end, preparing, verifying and organizing records and catching errors before they reach anyone else.
- Coordinate with external providers and government authorities on approvals, authorizations and renewals, following each case through review to completion.
- Work across CRM, portals, Excel, cloud drives and internal tools simultaneously to triage and resolve requests at first contact wherever possible.
- Write the SOPs and train colleagues whenever a new system or process is introduced.
- Built an automated reminder service that alerts colleagues before documents expire, plus the daily reporting management uses.

Operations and Program Coordinator

EL-Feky Educational Center | Tanta, Egypt | Jan 2023 - Jan 2025

- Ran the daily appointment calendar: bookings, cancellations, clashes and rescheduling, all handled the same day.
- Ran registration, intake and onboarding, and was first line for inquiries and complaints in person and by phone.
- Owned payment tracking: collected outstanding balances, reconciled accounts and followed up on overdue payments.
- Redesigned and documented the intake workflow, which cut record errors and shortened response times.

Operations and Marketing Assistant (Part-time)

EL-Feky Educational Center | Tanta, Egypt | Mar 2022 - Sep 2023

- Handled inbound inquiries and structured follow-up, and kept contact and account records accurate at volume.

General Dentist

Harmony Dental Clinic | Tanta, Egypt | Apr 2021 - Dec 2022

- Practicing clinician with a full daily caseload: history taking, examination, diagnosis, treatment planning, restorative and surgical treatment, and aftercare.
- Charted findings and wrote up clinical notes for every patient, keeping records complete, consistent and confidential.
- Coordinated prescriptions with pharmacies, raised and tracked lab work through to delivery, and prepared specialist referrals with follow-up to confirm patients were seen.
- Scheduled appointments and recalls, confirmed attendance, and cut no-shows through proactive follow-up.
- Explained diagnoses, treatment options and costs in plain language, and built enough trust with anxious and first-time patients for them to proceed.
- Collected treatment payments at the chair and handled the billing conversation directly with patients.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Dental Surgery (BDS), Tanta University, Egypt | Aug 2017 - Jun 2022

LANGUAGES

English (fluent) | Arabic (native) | German (conversational)

REMOTE WORK SETUP

Private home office, high-speed fiber internet with a backup connection and power backup, HD webcam and headset. Available full time on Pacific / California hours, and on Eastern, Central or Mountain hours if the practice needs them.